

DEAL INTELLIGENCE

Greystar's \$216M Arlington Sale Shows Multifamily Liquidity Is Narrow and Price-Sensitive

A 2023-vintage tower trades at \$510,000 per unit, revealing the bid depth for stabilized, well-located assets.

July 17, 2026 · Commercial Observer · 4 min read

A source-grounded Light Tower Insight. The complete note follows.

The 20-story tower at 2055 15th Street North in Arlington is the tallest residential building in the Court House neighborhood. It opened in 2023, sits next to a Metro station, and has ground-floor retail leased to a French café, a yoga studio, and a bowl chain. By any physical measure, this is a high-quality, well-located, recently delivered asset.

That Greystar sold it for \$215.8 million, or roughly \$510,000 per unit, is not the headline. The headline is that GID was willing to buy it at that basis, and that Greystar was willing to sell.

The transaction matters because it reveals the current shape of multifamily liquidity in the Washington, D.C., suburbs. Capital is available for the right asset, at the right price, between two institutional sponsors who understand the math. But the deal does not signal a broad reopening of the transaction market. It signals a narrow clearing price for a specific kind of property: stabilized, recently built, transit-oriented, and operated by a sponsor with credibility.

Greystar is not selling because it needs to. The firm completed a 231-unit high-rise across the street last year and maintains a presence in the submarket. The sale is better understood as a portfolio-management decision: take liquidity when it appears at a basis that allows redeployment into higher-return opportunities or markets where the bid is thinner. Greystar's cost basis on a 2023 delivery is likely below \$510,000 per unit, so the sale generates a profit that can be recycled.

GID, through its Windsor Communities subsidiary, is buying because the asset fits a known template. Windsor already operates Halstead Tower by Windsor in Alexandria, Io Piazza by Windsor in Arlington, and Ridgewood by Windsor in Fairfax. The firm knows the Northern Virginia market, the tenant base, and the operating costs. The acquisition expands a platform that already has scale in the region, which reduces execution risk. GID is not making a speculative bet on Arlington rents. It is buying an asset it can operate efficiently within an existing portfolio.

The price per unit, \$510,000, is the most revealing number in the deal. It is high enough to suggest that the asset is stabilized and generating cash flow. It is low enough to suggest that the buyer is not underwriting aggressive rent growth. In a market where construction costs for a similar tower would likely exceed \$500,000 per unit, the price reflects replacement cost plus a modest premium for

location and existing occupancy. That is a defensible basis, but not a cheap one.

Berkadia arranged the transaction for Greystar. The fact that a major brokerage was involved, and that the deal closed without public marketing drama, suggests that the buyer and seller had a pre-existing relationship or that the asset was shopped quietly to a narrow group of institutional buyers. That is consistent with a market where broad auctions produce uncertain results and where sellers prefer certainty of execution over price discovery.

The deal also highlights the bifurcation in multifamily capital markets. Stabilized, well-located, recently built assets in strong job markets can still trade. Older properties, those with deferred maintenance, or those in secondary locations face a much thinner bid. The spread between the two tiers has widened, and it is likely to persist as long as debt costs remain elevated and underwriting standards remain tight.

For owners of similar assets in the Washington region, the transaction provides a useful comp. A 2023-vintage tower near a Metro station with institutional sponsorship can command roughly \$510,000 per unit. That is a data point, not a floor. The next deal will depend on the specific basis, the sponsor's cost of capital, and the buyer's platform fit.

For lenders, the deal confirms that stabilized multifamily debt remains available for the right sponsor and asset. GID likely financed the acquisition with a combination of equity and debt, and the debt markets are open for a borrower of that quality on an asset of that vintage. The question is whether the same debt would be available for a 2015-vintage property in a less central location. The answer, in most cases, is no.

The transaction is not a signal that the multifamily transaction market has returned to normal. It is a signal that liquidity exists at a price, for a specific asset type, between two institutional players who understand the math. That is a narrow clearing, not a broad recovery.

The next test for the market is whether similar deals can be done for assets that are older, less well-located, or owned by sponsors with less balance-sheet credibility. If the bid widens, the market is

healing. If it stays narrow, the capital that is available will continue to concentrate around the safest bets.

SOURCES

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